

Text Template Manager

User Handbook

Version 0.0.0-dev · Marflow Software

Introduction

Text Template Manager is a Windows application for storing reusable pieces of text — email replies, code snippets, standard responses, boilerplate — and inserting them into any other application with a keystroke. Templates are organized in folders, can be given keyboard- shortcuts, and can optionally be shared with a team through a synchronized file.

This handbook describes every feature of the application. Throughout, a menu path is written in the form **Menu > Item** (for example, **Settings > General**), and keyboard input is shown in bold (for example, **Alt**). The installed version is shown under **Help > About**.

The main window

The main window is divided into two panes:

- The **left pane** contains the template tree and a search box. The tree holds your folders and templates, including any synchronized folders, which are pinned to the top.
- The **right pane** shows the editor for the currently selected template, or the title field for a selected folder. When nothing is selected, it shows a placeholder.

The toolbar above the tree provides buttons to add a template, add a folder, and delete the selected item. The menu bar provides the **File** and **Help** menus, and the quick-help button in the top-right corner opens a short in-app reference.

Templates and folders

Creating items

Use the toolbar to add a new template or folder. New items are placed relative to the current selection: inside the selected folder, alongside a selected template, or at the top level when nothing is selected. New items are given a unique default name, which you can change at any time.

Organizing the tree

Drag items to reorder them or to move them between folders. Folders may contain both templates and other folders; a template is always a leaf and can never contain other items. Expansion and selection are preserved as you work.

The template editor

Selecting a template opens it in the rich-text editor, which supports bold, italic, underline, strikethrough, text and highlight colors, headings, bulleted and numbered lists, and tables. Changes

are saved automatically a short time after you stop typing, so there is no separate save step.

Template properties

Each template exposes the following properties:

- **Title** — the display name, shown in the tree and searchable.
- **Tags** — optional, comma-separated keywords that are also included in search.
- **Default paste mode** — the format used when the template is pasted (see below).
- **Single-key shortcut** and **Multi-key shortcut** — optional shortcuts for the Quick Paste window (see *Keyboard shortcuts and conflicts*).

Paste modes

The paste mode determines how a template is placed on the clipboard and inserted into the target application:

Mode	Description
Auto	Chooses the most suitable format for the target application.
Plaintext	Unformatted text only.
Markdown	Markdown source text.
RTF	Rich Text Format.
HTML	HTML markup.

Quick Paste

Quick Paste is a compact window that lets you insert a template into whichever application you were using, without leaving the keyboard.

Press the configured global hotkey (see **Settings > General**) from any application to open it. Quick Paste remembers the application you came from and returns focus to it when a template is pasted.

Inserting a template

- **Single-key shortcut** — with the search box empty, press the key assigned to a template to paste it immediately. If the same key is assigned in more than one area, the local template takes precedence, followed by synchronized folders in their configured order.
- **Multi-key shortcut** — hold **Alt**, type the shortcut, and release **Alt** to paste. Shortcuts in synchronized folders are prefixed with the folder's prefix (for example, and-msg). The characters -, _, and . are permitted as separators. Press **Backspace** while holding **Alt** to correct a mistyped entry.
- **Paste as plain text** — end a multi-key entry with **Shift + -** (which produces _) to insert the template as unformatted text, regardless of its default paste mode.
- **Search** — type in the search box to filter the tree; matching templates display their folder path.

Double-click any template, in either the tree or the shortcut lists, to paste it.

The shortcut lists at the bottom of the window show the available single-key and multi-key shortcuts, together with the area each belongs to (a synchronized folder's name, or *local*).

Keyboard shortcuts and conflicts

Every shortcut belongs to an **area**. An area is either a specific synchronized folder or the set of everything outside synchronization (referred to as *local*).

- A **single-key** shortcut may be reused in different areas. When a key is assigned in more than one area, Quick Paste resolves it by priority: the local template first, then synchronized folders in the order configured in settings. Assigning the same single key twice **within the same area** is a conflict and is not permitted; the application reports it and does not save the duplicate.
- A **multi-key** shortcut is namespaced by its folder's prefix, so identical shortcuts in different folders do not collide. A genuine duplicate within one area is reported and not saved.

Cross-area single-key duplicates are permitted and are shown as an informational note rather than an error. When you move a template into an area that already uses its shortcut, the application resolves the clash automatically: a duplicate single-key shortcut is removed from the moved template, and a duplicate multi-key shortcut receives a numeric suffix (for example, MSG becomes MSG1).

Any outstanding conflicts and notes are listed in a small floating panel in the main window.

Synchronization

Synchronization lets several people, or several of your own computers, share the same set of templates. A synchronized source is an ordinary template file that is stored in a shared location — most commonly a cloud folder such as OneDrive — and surfaced in the tree as a pinned folder at the top.

Synchronized files are watched for external changes and reconciled automatically, so edits made elsewhere appear without restarting the application.

Configuring sources

Manage synchronized sources under **Settings > Sync**. You can link an existing shared file or create a new one, and each source offers the following options:

- **Active** — load the source into the tree as a pinned folder. Clearing this hides the folder without deleting the underlying file.
- **Save** — when enabled, the folder is editable and your changes are written back to the shared file. When disabled, the folder is read-only and the shared file always takes precedence on reload.
- **Name** — the folder's title as shown on this computer.
- **Prefix** — the text that namespaces the folder's multi-key shortcuts (for example, a prefix of `and` turns the shortcut `msg` into `and-msg`). The character joining the prefix and the shortcut is set by the separator field; the permitted separators are `-`, `_`, and `..`.

- **Order** — the up and down arrows set the folder's priority. This priority determines which template wins when a single key is shared across areas, and is applied immediately.

If a source's file cannot be found (for example, it has been moved or is temporarily offline), a warning icon is shown next to it. Click the icon to re-link the source to its file. The most recently cached contents remain visible in the meantime.

Settings

Open settings from **File > Settings**.

General

- **Run at Windows login** — starts the application automatically when you sign in to Windows.
- **Automatically check for updates** — periodically checks for a newer release and offers to install it. See *Updates*.
- **Default paste mode** — the paste mode applied to newly created templates.
- **Global shortcut** — the hotkey that opens the Quick Paste window from any application. Click the field and press the desired key combination to change it.

Sync

Manage synchronized sources, as described in *Synchronization*.

Backup and export

- **File > Save Backup** and **File > Load Backup** export and import your entire template tree as a single file.
 - Right-clicking a folder and choosing **Export** saves just that folder and its contents to a standalone file, which is useful for creating a new shared source or sharing a subset of templates.
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Updates

When automatic update checking is enabled, the application checks for a newer release on startup and periodically thereafter, and you can also check on demand from **Help > Check for Updates**.

When a newer version is available, it is downloaded in the background and an **Update now** button appears in the top-right corner of the main window. You are prompted to install immediately or to defer; deferring keeps the button available and prompts again on the next start. Installing closes the application, applies the update silently, and reopens it.

Keyboard reference

Context	Input	Action
Main window	Delete	Delete the selected item (with confirmation).
Main window	Ctrl + C	Copy the selected template in its default paste mode.
Quick Paste	<i>key</i>	Paste by single-key shortcut (search box empty).
Quick Paste	Alt + keys	Paste by multi-key shortcut; release Alt to insert.
Quick Paste	Alt + Backspace	Correct the current multi-key entry.
Quick Paste	Esc	Close the Quick Paste window.

Additional actions are available from the right-click menu, including **Duplicate**, **Copy**, and **Copy As** for templates, and **Export** for folders.

Data and file locations

Application data is stored per user under:

%LocalAppData%\Marflow Software\TextTemplatesManager

This folder contains your template data, application settings, and synchronization configuration. Downloaded update installers are staged in an installer subfolder. Shared synchronization files are stored wherever you place them, and are not kept in this folder.

Support

For questions, permission requests, or to report an issue, contact contact@kmarflow.com, or visit the project on GitHub via **Help > Go to GitHub**.